



The spikes of nodding flowers may grow to a height of 24 in (60 cm).

Spotted fritillary

Some plants can grow **up to 20,177 ft** (6,150 m) above sea level.



Mountain buttercup

This wild plant stays very short to avoid strong winds.



Haleakala silversword

This endangered Hawaiian plant grows on the edge of a volcano at more than 6,900 ft (2,100 m). Its swordlike leaves are covered in silver hair.

Even the flower heads of the prostrate speedwell grow close to the ground.

Prostrate speedwell



This beautiful plant survives extreme cold, but not drought.



Himalayan may apple

Fine white hairs that look like cobwebs reduce heat and water loss.

Long-petaled lewisia

This rare plant is found only near Lake Tahoe in California.



Mountain plants have adapted to the dry climate of their habitat in different ways. The **alpine spotted orchid** and **spotted fritillary** survive the cold winter as bulbs, flowering in spring. The **Himalayan may apple** cannot tolerate bright, dry conditions, so it grows quickly in spring and then dies back underground for the rest of the year. Others, such as the **broadleaf stonecrop**, **alpine pink**, **cobweb house-leek**, and **long-petaled lewisia** produce short, sturdy leaves, and survive all year by staying close to the ground for protection from the wind.